

“Ah! I’m a Slime!”

Game Ideation

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Premise

- Genre: PVE, 2D sidescroller-platformer, survival-horror.
- Context: Play as the classic fantasy monster, the slime, in a world where everything tries to kill you.
- Design goal: An eerie game with sketchy cartoon visuals and sounds to match that induce anxiety in each element of gameplay.
- Selling point: Experience the challenges and thrills of both platformers and survival-horror games like platforming, combat, exploration, stealth, escape, and so on; all with the added pressure of being a weak slime in a hostile world.

Narrative

- Setting: A fantasy world ruined by the apocalypse. All that remains are monsters (i.e: other slimes, goblins, zombies, etc.), ruins of civilization, and remnants of magic.
- Protagonist: Players will play as a slime that has gained enhanced autonomy and intelligence, in comparison to other monsters.
- Main goal: Survive and find safety from the post apocalyptic world.
- Antagonist: The hostile monster filled world.

MDA

Core system & mechanics: Movement

- Players will have to utilize the slime's movement and slime abilities to explore, platform, solve puzzles, sneak past, escape from, or fight other monsters.
 - Basic movement (walk & jump)
 - Slime puddle (crouch)
 - Slippery slime (dash & sprint)
 - Bouncy slime (wall jump)
 - Sticky slime (climb, ceiling traversal)
 - Slime platform (air jump)

Supporting systems & mechanics

- Resources: players will have to manage 2 resources to survive and fight.
 - Slime: Health resource, running out of slime leads to death.
 - Mana: Combat resource, further separated into subtypes (water, ice, earth, fire, lightning) like different ammo types in survival-horror games.
- Combat: Even as a slime, the player has minimal combat abilities.

- Tackle (melee attack, very little damage)
- Consume (finisher on staggered enemies, automatically stores enemy's item drop if they had one)
- Water Shot (handgun, uses water mana)
- Icicle Volley (machine gun, uses ice mana)
- Rock Blast (shot gun, uses earth mana)
- Fire Ball (grenade launcher, uses fire mana)
- Lightning Strike (sniper, uses lightning mana)
- Items: The player will come across various items that they can pick up to store in their inventory, restore resources, or upgrade abilities.
 - Slime droplets: Restore health
 - Slime vials: Store in inventory, can be used later to restore health
 - Mana crystals: Store in inventory
 - Quest/puzzle items: Store in inventory, can be used later to progress quests or solve puzzles
 - Throwing items: Store in inventory, can be used later to throw and distract enemies
 - Upgrade items: Upgrades movement abilities, defense, and attack
- Inventory & quick use: The player can view their inventory to use/drop/sort items, or assign them for quick use.
- Enemy detection: If players enter an enemy's detection range AND sight line, the enemy will pursue and attack the player until:
 - The enemy is defeated.
 - The player escapes the enemy's area of pursuit.
 - The player hides while out of the enemy's sight and remains hidden for a certain period of time.
- Map: The player can view a map of the area, items/places of interest will be automatically marked on the map once they are seen, and the map will change colour to indicate the player has completed the area.

Dynamics

- Game flow is mostly linear. Players can freely explore each area to an extent, but still progress through by completing platforming levels, puzzles, and combat/stealth encounters. After completing an area they move to the next, prior areas are never blocked off, but no shortcuts will exist for easy back tracking. Some areas will have in-game cutscenes to provide tutorial or narrative needed to advance to the next area.
- Gameplay loop consists of:

1. Enter new area.
 2. Explore and find:
 - a. Items
 - b. Platforming levels
 - c. Puzzles
 - d. Enemy encounters (combat, stealth, or escape)
 - e. Boss encounters (stealth or escape)
 - f. In-game cutscenes
 3. Repeat 1-2 until area completed (or able to progress to next)
 4. In some cases, be forced to defeat, trap, or escape the area boss before continuing to the next area
- Potential emergent playstyles and feedback loops:
 - Game mainly pressures players to use their movement and pick the best course of action: either combat, stealth, or escape. However, players can still choose to either: play slower, stealthier, and safer, avoiding detection and using less resources; or be more aggressive and risky, engaging enemies in combat more often, using more resources to make exploration afterwards easier; or they can play a rushed and thrilling playstyle where they neither sneak past or defeat enemies, but are constantly being pursued by them while progressing through the area.
 - If engaging in combat, players can also choose which spells they like most and form different playstyles around that (burst vs constant damage, close vs far range, precision vs spread, etc.), albeit this choice is limited by mana as once a mana type runs out, they must switch to a different spell

Aesthetics

Core experience is anxiety-inducing, eerie, “get the fuck away from me!” or “leave me alone!”

Market & Platform

- Game will be most enjoyed by players who seek mastery over the challenges of platforming, stealth, and managing resources, but also by players who enjoy a bit of action and fantasy.
- Target audience are teenagers and anyone older who can master challenging game mechanics, enjoy thrillers, and appreciate cartoonish but eerie graphics
- Target platform is PC, easiest way to distribute independently.

Art & Sound

- Art will be sketchy, cartoonish, and eerie. Lots of shadows and visual noise, reserving sharper/brighter/more vibrant features for things that want to be attended to by the player.
- Depending on the moment, sound effects can: echo and reverb for empty eeriness; ring and pierce for sharp panic; or boom and build to induce anxiety
- Similar to sound effects, music will depend on the moment and set the tone of either eerie suspense, building anxiety, or full blown panic

Other Inspirations

- Playing as the weakest RPG enemy, the slime (inspired by the anime “That Time I got Reincarnated as a Slime”)
- Platforming like “Hollow Knight”, survival-horror elements like “Resident Evil”.